Quick Setup

DealScout needs only Node.js — no database, no npm packages, no containers.

- Install Node.js (LTS) from https://nodejs.org/.
- Extract the dealscout folder.
- Windows: double-click setup.bat.
- macOS/Linux: run chmod +x setup.sh && ./setup.sh.
- The browser opens http://localhost:3000 automatically.

SETUP TIP

Speak clearly, demonstrate the real flow, and separate implemented behavior from planned enhancements.

Manual Start and Folder Layout

Any terminal works too.

- cd dealscout
- node server.js (or: npm start)
- server.js — HTTP server; modules/ — api, products, auth, analytics, filestore.
- public/ — HTML, CSS, JS, downloads; data/ — products.json, users.json, searches.json.
- Change the port with PORT=4000 node server.js.

SETUP TIP

Speak clearly, demonstrate the real flow, and separate implemented behavior from planned enhancements.

Optional Live Provider

Sample prices work without credentials. Live shopping requires a server-side key.

- Get a SerpApi key.
- Windows: set SERPAPI_KEY=your_key then node server.js
- macOS/Linux: SERPAPI_KEY=your_key node server.js
- Never place the provider key in browser code.

SETUP TIP

Speak clearly, demonstrate the real flow, and separate implemented behavior from planned enhancements.

Operations and Login

Use these notes when maintaining the local installation.

- Stop: press Ctrl+C in the terminal window.
- Reset history: replace the contents of data/searches.json with []
- Add products: edit data/products.json and restart.
- Preview login: preview@dealscout.local / dealscout123

SETUP TIP

Speak clearly, demonstrate the real flow, and separate implemented behavior from planned enhancements.